



TUTOR/MENTOR CONNECTION

RESEARCH AND INFORMATION SYSTEM ASSOCIATE (RISA)

<http://www.tutormentorconnection.org>

Cabrini Connections is unique in combining community-based direct services (**Kids' Connection**) with comprehensive citywide actions (**Tutor/Mentor Connection (T/MC)**) intended to empower and encourage a growing army of adult volunteers to give their time and effort on behalf of children in disadvantaged environments such as Cabrini-Green. We have stretched the meaning of the terms "tutor" and "mentor" to describe a long-term commitment of adult organizations to help at-risk kids move through school and into careers.

The **Tutor/Mentor Connection (T/MC)** was designed to help afterschool tutor/mentor programs grow and expand in every area where children live in poverty or attend poorly performing schools. The T/MC helps programs in the following ways: 1) it raises dollars to fund general operations; 2) it recruits volunteers for different programs; 3) it draws media visibility to every program; 4) it provides training and free one-on-one consulting to leaders of existing programs and organizers of new programs; 5) it encourages networking and idea sharing among programs via conferences and a quarterly newsletter; 6) it has produced Chicago's most comprehensive Directory of tutor/mentor programs and distributes this free of charge to more than 3000 businesses, churches, schools, libraries and potential volunteers each year; 7) it conducts research to locate programs and quantify the availability of programs in different neighborhoods and serving different age groups; and it is using the internet as an on-line library which is open to students, volunteers, parents and program leaders 24 hours a day.

If you are interested in this type of internship, please call 312-573-8851. Email, CabriniC@aol.com

Title: Research and Information System Associate (RISA)

Date needed: Immediately

Duration of position: One year preferred.

Hours per week: 10 to 20; more if available

Work location: Chicago area preferred, but flexible depending on skill and experience. Stable Internet access is required.

Compensation: \$10 - \$13/hour depending on experience.

Who may apply: Anyone with the experience and competencies described below. (Open to all undergraduate and graduate majors).

Work description: RISAs will help develop and implement an Internet-based information and evaluation system. The system will be used by organizations and programs worldwide that provide tutoring and mentoring services or support their existence. The primary purpose of this system will be to help organizations and their stakeholders to understand and improve (1) the effectiveness of tutor/mentor programs and organizations and (2) the capacity of business, civic, and other community sectors to support tutoring/mentoring as a way to improve outcomes for children and youth (e.g., academic and social skills, school-to-work, etc). The system will be used to synthesize data and conduct applied research studies for individual and groups of

organizations. RISA activities include the development of Internet and off-line information system tools and procedures, data collection, entry, and analysis, and preparation of reports and professional presentations. This work requires interaction with people of all ages and from all community sectors. Some training will be provided. Opportunities and support are available for independent research.

Necessary experience and competencies: Ability to work well with others, independent thinker, leadership, curiosity, creativity, an interest in community improvement efforts, excellent reading, writing, and typing ability, word processing, and Internet and email use. Experience with data management and applied research is a plus.

For more information or to apply, please send a resume or brief CV as an attached email file to **opportunities@tutormentorexchange.net**

Cabrini Connections

Tutor/Mentor Connection

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Ph: 312-573-8851

Fax: 312-573-8816

Email: CabriniC@aol.com

Princeton Project 55 Position Description:
Tutor/Mentor Connection Research and Knowledge Sharing Associate (RKSA)

Requirements:

This work requires interaction with people of all ages and from all community sectors. Some training will be provided. Opportunities and support are available for independent research.

The candidate should have a strong interest in helping inner city youth have more effective paths to jobs and careers and a strong desire to improve tutor/mentor programs and develop an infrastructure to sustain and expand capacity of comprehensive, mentor-rich tutor/mentor programs.

The candidate should have a demonstrated ability to work well with others, in person and via telephone and email. We seek an independent thinker, a leader, a hard worker and a person who is creative in applying new solutions to old problems. The candidate also must have excellent verbal and written communication skills, and an ability to work well independently and with a team.

Experience with data management and applied research is a plus. Competence in common word processor software (Word, WordPerfect) and data analysis software (Excel, ACCESS, FileMakerPro), fluent use of Internet technologies including email, list groups, and searching the Internet (website development is a plus), and familiarity with the basics of program evaluation.

Princeton Project 55 Position Description: Tutor/Mentor Connection Research and Knowledge Sharing Associate (RKSA)

Responsibilities:

The T/MC Research and Knowledge Sharing Associate (RKSA) is responsible for developing, maintaining and distributing the information and information resources of the Tutor/Mentor Connection (T/MC). This includes (1) maintaining and expanding the T/MC database of existing tutor/mentor programs in the Chicago region, (2) working with computer professionals to create GIS maps showing the location of tutor/mentor programs location of program volunteers, business partners and donors, and factors important to understanding the outcomes of tutor/mentor programs (e.g., high school graduation rates, schools on probation), (3) working with the T/MC evaluation partners to coordinate and help implement evaluation projects for T/MC and tutor/mentor programs, (4) working with the T/MC technology partners to transform existing T/MC knowledge systems into Internet-based tools for the tutor/mentor community, and (5) organizing and preparing reports to share best practices and lessons about effective tutor/mentor programs with the media, on the Internet, and at semi-annual T/MC leadership conferences.

Work which intern will do:

- Systematically contact ever one of 370 tutor/mentor locations listed in T/MC Directory and collect information of what they do, how they do it, who they serve, how many they serve, and what there needs are. This contact cycle peaks in late June with the publication of the annual Tutor/Mentor Directory, which is a "yellow-pages" listing of every tutor/mentor program in Chicago
- Conduct on-going market research to learn about tutor/mentor best practices anywhere in the country. Add this information to the T/MC library and web site and prepare reviews of these programs for distribution in the T/MC newsletter, web site and through T/MC conferences
- Help develop and implement an Internet-based information and evaluation system, while doing data collection/input into an 8-year retrospective T/MC review using this system. (see inset).
- Research and write human interest stories about tutors and students in tutor/mentor programs throughout the city. These stories will be distributed via T/MC web site, T/MC newsletters and as T/MC media releases.
- Organize and catalog T/MC research in ways that more

users can access information

- Assist in development of May or November tutor/mentor leadership conference (format, marketing, logistics, design, speaker recruitment, etc.)
- Assist in development of annual citywide tutor/mentor volunteer recruitment campaign. Recruiting corporate sponsors, tutor/mentor programs and media support.

Internet-based information and evaluation system:

Part of the RKSA Intern's responsibility will be to help develop and implement an Internet-based information and evaluation system which will first be piloted with the Tutor/Mentor Connection, then with our own Kids' Connection. As the system becomes operational, it will be offered for use by organizations and programs world-wide that provide tutoring and mentoring services or support their existence.

The primary purpose of this system will be to help organizations and their stakeholders to understand and improve (1) the effectiveness of tutor/mentor programs and organizations and (2) the capacity of business, civic, and other community sectors to support tutoring/mentoring as a way to improve outcomes for children and youth (e.g., academic and social skills, school-to-work, etc).

The system will be used to synthesize data and conduct applied research studies for individual and groups of organizations. RKSA activities include the development of Internet and off-line information system tools and procedures, data collection, entry, and analysis, and preparation of reports and professional presentations. This work requires interaction with people of all ages and from all community sectors. Some training will be provided. Opportunities and support are available for independent research.

For more information, visit:

www.tutormentorconnection.org

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<http://jordan-webb.net/tmc>